

D574

Neuropsychology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 45-year-old architect who owns a sailboat suffers a brain injury in a car crash. Afterward he makes impulsive purchases, cannot plan his workday, and speaks rudely in meetings, though his vision and hearing are normal. He has two daughters in college. Which lobe was most likely damaged?

- A. Temporal lobe.
- B. Parietal lobe.
- C. Occipital lobe.
- D. Frontal lobe.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

After a left-hemisphere stroke, a retired chef who loves opera speaks in slow, effortful phrases such as “Walk ... dog ... park,” but follows spoken instructions well and is frustrated by his speech. His wife says he used to sing every morning. Which aphasia best fits?

- A. Global aphasia.
- B. Broca’s aphasia.
- C. Wernicke’s aphasia.
- D. A music-processing disorder, since he no longer sings.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient speaks fluently and quickly but uses wrong or made-up words, cannot follow simple commands, and seems unaware of errors. Where is the damage most likely?

- A. Any area of the brain, since language is spread evenly.
- B. Right occipital lobe.
- C. Left frontal lobe (Broca’s area).
- D. Left temporal lobe (Wernicke’s area).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

After surgery that removed parts of both hippocampi, a man who once worked as a mechanic practices a mirror-drawing task each day and steadily improves. Each day he insists he has never done the task before. He enjoys crossword puzzles. What does this show?

- A. All memory depends on the hippocampus.
- B. His mechanic background explains the skill gain.
- C. Procedural (implicit) memory can work without the hippocampus, while new explicit memories cannot form.
- D. He has retrograde amnesia only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A researcher at a lab with a new microscope records a single sensory neuron while pressing lightly, then firmly, on a person's fingertip. The lab is funded by a national science grant. What most likely differs in the neuron's response to the firm press?

- A. The neuron fires more action potentials per second.
- B. Nothing changes, since neurons respond the same way to every stimulus.
- C. The neuron fires fewer action potentials.
- D. Each action potential is larger.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A neuron's membrane is depolarized to a level just below threshold. What happens?

- A. The neuron fires at a higher rate.
- B. A full action potential fires, since any depolarization triggers one.
- C. No action potential fires.
- D. A small action potential fires.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A woman who teaches elementary art has a stroke in her right hemisphere. She lives with her sister and a parrot. Which side of the body is most likely to show weakness?

- A. Both sides equally.
- B. The left side.
- C. The right side.
- D. Her dominant painting hand, whichever side it is.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A split-brain patient sees a picture of a key flashed only in her left visual field. Which hemisphere receives the image, and what can she most likely do?

- A. Both hemispheres; she can name it and pick it out.
- B. The right hemisphere; she cannot name it aloud but can pick out a key with her left hand.
- C. The right hemisphere; she can pick it out with her right hand.
- D. The left hemisphere; she can name it aloud.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A 58-year-old bus driver who enjoys bowling loses movement in his right hand after a stroke. After months of intense, repetitive practice using the weak hand, he regains much of its function. Brain scans show nearby areas now active during hand movement. His therapy clinic has free parking. What does this show?

- A. Bowling kept his hand strong.
- B. Adult brains cannot reorganize, so the stroke must have been misdiagnosed.
- C. The dead neurons regenerated completely.
- D. Neuroplasticity: intact areas took over function through practice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A woman who works as a librarian has rare bilateral amygdala damage. She recognizes happiness and surprise in faces but cannot recognize fear, and she rates untrustworthy-looking strangers as approachable. She enjoys gardening. Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. The amygdala is important for detecting fear and social threat.
- B. She has a general visual problem.
- C. The hippocampus controls fear recognition.
- D. The amygdala controls all emotions equally.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A research team with a large federal grant wants to know exactly when, within milliseconds, the brain distinguishes a familiar face from an unfamiliar one. The team's lab is in a historic building. Which method is best suited?

- A. A lesion study.
- B. fMRI.
- C. EEG.
- D. Any method, since all brain imaging has the same timing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An fMRI study shows a region becomes active when people judge distances. Which follow-up would best test whether that region is necessary for the judgment?

- A. Temporarily disrupt the region with TMS or study patients with damage there, and check whether distance judgments suffer.
- B. Record EEG to see when the region responds.
- C. Nothing more is needed; activation proves the region is necessary.
- D. Repeat the fMRI with more participants.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A 45-year-old architect ~~who owns a sailboat~~ suffers a brain injury in a car crash. Afterward he makes impulsive purchases, cannot plan his workday, and speaks rudely in meetings, though his vision and hearing are normal. ~~He has two daughters in college.~~ Which lobe was most likely damaged?

Target word: lobe from deficits **Decides:** Planning, impulse control, and social conduct.

A	Adjacent category	Temporal damage affects hearing, language comprehension, and memory.
B	Dropped element	Parietal damage affects touch and spatial attention; drops the planning and impulse clues.
C	Confusion set	Occipital damage affects vision, which is normal here.
D	Correct	Executive functions and impulse control depend on the frontal lobes.

2. Answer B Concept 2

After a left-hemisphere stroke, a retired chef ~~who loves opera~~ speaks in slow, effortful phrases such as “Walk ... dog ... park,” but follows spoken instructions well and is frustrated by his speech. ~~His wife says he used to sing every morning.~~ Which aphasia best fits?

Target word: aphasia type **Decides:** Effortful speech with good comprehension.

A	Adjacent category	Global aphasia impairs both production and comprehension; his comprehension is good.
B	Correct	Halting speech with relatively intact comprehension points to left frontal damage.
C	Inverted operation	Wernicke’s produces fluent speech with poor comprehension—the reverse.
D	Camouflage	The singing detail does not decide the language deficit.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

A patient speaks fluently and quickly but uses wrong or made-up words, cannot follow simple commands, and seems unaware of errors. Where is the damage most likely?

Target word: location from symptoms — reverse direction **Decides:** Fluent speech with poor comprehension.

A	Absolute language	Core language functions are strongly lateralized to the left in most people.
B	Adjacent category	Visual processing, not language.
C	Inverted operation	Broca’s damage produces effortful speech with better comprehension.
D	Correct	Wernicke’s aphasia: fluent but meaningless speech, poor comprehension.

4. Answer C Concept 3

After surgery that removed parts of both hippocampi, a man ~~who once worked as a mechanic~~ practices a mirror-drawing task each day and steadily improves. Each day he insists he has never done the task before. ~~He enjoys crossword puzzles.~~ What does this show?

Target word: which memory system is spared **Decides:** Skill improves without conscious memory.

A	Absolute language	His improvement shows procedural learning survives.
B	Camouflage	Past work does not explain daily improvement on a new task.
C	Correct	Skill learning is spared; conscious recall of the practice is lost.
D	Confusion set	His problem is forming new memories—anterograde.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A researcher at a lab ~~with a new microscope~~ records a single sensory neuron while pressing lightly, then firmly, on a person's fingertip. ~~The lab is funded by a national science grant.~~ What most likely differs in the neuron's response to the firm press?

Target word: how intensity is coded **Decides:** All-or-none firing.

A	Correct	Intensity is coded by firing rate; each spike is the same size.
B	Absolute language	Firing rate changes with intensity.
C	Inverted operation	Stronger stimuli increase, not decrease, firing.
D	Confusion set	Action potentials are all-or-none and do not grow with stimulus strength.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A neuron's membrane is depolarized to a level just below threshold. What happens?

Target word: sub-threshold outcome **Decides:** No threshold, no action potential.

A	Inverted operation	Rate increases come from stronger, above-threshold input.
B	Absolute language	Threshold must be reached.
C	Correct	Below threshold, the all-or-none spike does not occur.
D	Confusion set	There are no partial action potentials.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A woman ~~who teaches elementary art~~ has a stroke in her right hemisphere. ~~She lives with her sister and a parrot.~~ Which side of the body is most likely to show weakness?

Target word: side affected **Decides:** Contralateral motor control.

A	Dropped element	Drops the one-sided nature of motor control.
B	Correct	The right hemisphere controls movement on the left side.
C	Inverted operation	Motor control is contralateral.
D	Camouflage	Her art work does not change which side is affected.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A split-brain patient sees a picture of a key flashed only in her left visual field. Which hemisphere receives the image, and what can she most likely do?

Target word: visual field to hemisphere **Decides:** Left visual field → right hemisphere, which usually lacks speech.

A	Dropped element	Drops the cut corpus callosum that blocks sharing.
B	Correct	The right hemisphere sees it and controls the left hand but usually lacks speech output.
C	Confusion set	The right hemisphere controls the left hand.
D	Inverted operation	Left visual field input goes to the right hemisphere.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A 58-year-old bus driver ~~who enjoys bowling~~ loses movement in his right hand after a stroke. After months of intense, repetitive practice using the weak hand, he regains much of its function. Brain scans show nearby areas now active during hand movement. ~~His therapy clinic has free parking.~~ What does this show?

Target word: mechanism of recovery **Decides:** Practice-driven reorganization.

A	Camouflage	The recovery followed targeted practice after the stroke.
B	Absolute language	Plasticity continues in adulthood.
C	Adjacent category	Recovery mainly comes from reorganization, not full regrowth of lost tissue.
D	Correct	Experience-dependent reorganization supports recovery.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A woman ~~who works as a librarian~~ has rare bilateral amygdala damage. She recognizes happiness and surprise in faces but cannot recognize fear, and she rates untrustworthy-looking strangers as approachable. ~~She enjoys gardening.~~ Which conclusion is best supported?

Target word: amygdala role **Decides:** Selective loss of fear recognition and threat judgment.

A	Correct	Its loss selectively impairs fear recognition and trust judgments.
B	Adjacent category	She recognizes other emotions, so vision is intact.
C	Confusion set	The hippocampus supports memory formation, not fear detection in faces.
D	Absolute language	Her other emotion recognition is spared.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A research team ~~with a large federal grant~~ wants to know exactly when, within milliseconds, the brain distinguishes a familiar face from an unfamiliar one. ~~The team's lab is in a historic building.~~ Which method is best suited?

Target word: method for timing **Decides:** Millisecond timing.

A	Adjacent category	Lesion studies test whether a region is necessary, not timing.
B	Confusion set	fMRI shows where activity occurs but tracks slow blood-flow changes over seconds.
C	Correct	EEG records electrical activity with millisecond precision.
D	Absolute language	Methods differ greatly in temporal resolution.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

An fMRI study shows a region becomes active when people judge distances. Which follow-up would best test whether that region is necessary for the judgment?

Target word: test necessity, not correlation **Decides:** Disrupt the region and see if the function fails.

A	Correct	Only disrupting a region tests whether it is required.
B	Adjacent category	EEG adds timing, not proof of necessity.
C	Inverted operation	Treats a correlational result as causal.
D	Confusion set	More activation data still shows correlation, not necessity.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Lobe functions	Frontal lobes support planning, impulse control, and voluntary movement; parietal lobes handle touch and spatial attention; temporal lobes handle hearing, language comprehension, and memory; occipital lobes handle vision.	Placing vision in the frontal lobe or planning in the occipital lobe.	A specific deficit after damage to one region.
2	Broca's vs. Wernicke's aphasia	Broca's aphasia (left frontal) produces slow, effortful speech with relatively good comprehension; Wernicke's aphasia (left temporal) produces fluent but meaningless speech with poor comprehension.	Assuming fluent speech means intact language.	Fluent nonsense vs. halting, telegraphic speech.
3	Hippocampus and memory systems	Hippocampal damage causes anterograde amnesia for new facts and events (explicit memory) while procedural (implicit) learning such as motor skills is largely spared.	Believing hippocampal damage erases all learning.	A patient who improves at a skill but cannot recall practicing.
4	All-or-none neural firing	An action potential fires fully once threshold is reached or not at all; stronger stimuli are signaled by a higher firing rate and more neurons firing, not by bigger action potentials.	Thinking a stronger stimulus makes each action potential larger.	A question about how intensity is coded.
5	Contralateral organization	Each hemisphere receives sensory input from and controls movement of the opposite side of the body; information from the left visual field goes to the right hemisphere.	Linking the left visual field to the left hemisphere.	A stroke on one side with symptoms on the other, or split-brain tasks.
6	Neuroplasticity	The brain reorganizes connections in response to experience and injury; practice-driven rehabilitation can shift functions to intact areas, with greater plasticity in younger brains but continuing across life.	Believing the adult brain cannot change.	Recovery or skill-driven change after injury or training.
7	Amygdala and social threat	The amygdala rapidly detects threat and emotional salience, including fear in faces; damage reduces fear recognition and can make people approach others they would normally distrust.	Assigning face-fear recognition to the hippocampus or occipital lobe.	Trouble recognizing fear or judging untrustworthy faces.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Methods: fMRI, EEG, lesion studies	fMRI has good spatial resolution (where) but poor timing; EEG has excellent timing (when) but poor localization; lesion and TMS studies test whether a region is necessary for a function.	Choosing fMRI for millisecond timing or treating fMRI activation as proof a region is necessary.	“Where,” “when,” or “is it necessary?”

Course scope (public description): Neuropsychology covers how brain processes relate to human cognition and behavior. Students will understand typical cognitive function in a person’s everyday life, major cognitive processes and neurophysiology involved in human sensation and perception, and insights from social neurobiology on the interaction between brain processes and social behaviors. There are no prerequisites for this course.